

Assignment: Using a New York Times API in R

The New York Times provides multiple public APIs via its developer portal (NYT Developer Network). To use any NYT API, you must first **create an account and obtain an API key**.

Your task:

1. **Choose one** New York Times API endpoint (e.g., Article Search, Most Popular, Books, etc.). You should use your data analysis to ask and attempt to answer an interesting question of your choosing. Examples: “What are the top five best selling hard cover books?”, “Which newspaper sections have produced the most popular articles, and how has this changed compared to X years ago?”, etc.
2. In **R**, write code to:
 - Authenticate using your API key. Never hard code an API key. There are a number of good ways to do this. For example: Store it in an environment variable (e.g., `Sys.getenv("NYT_API_KEY")`).
 - Make a request to the endpoint
 - Parse the **JSON** response
 - Transform the result into a clean **R data frame** (tibble is fine)

Deliverable

- A single Quarto (.qmd) document that includes:
 - The API you selected (endpoint + brief description)
 - The request you made (parameters used)
 - Code that returns a tidy data frame
 - A short note describing any data-cleaning decisions (e.g., nested fields, missing values)
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APIs

THE ARTICLE SEARCH API

Search Times articles from 1851 to today, retrieving headlines, abstracts and links to associated multimedia.

THE BOOKS API

Retrieve New York Times book reviews and get data from all best-seller lists.

THE CAMPAIGN FINANCE API

Get presidential campaign contribution and expenditure data based on United States Federal Election Commission filings.

THE COMMUNITY API

Get comments by NYTimes.com users.

THE CONGRESS API

Get U.S. Congressional vote data, including information about specific House and Senate members.

THE DISTRICTS API

Get political districts based on a pair of coordinates. Currently, the Districts API is limited to New York City.

THE EVENT LISTINGS API

Get information about hand-picked events in New York City and the surrounding area.

THE GEOGRAPHIC API

Use linked data to enhance location concepts used in The New York Times' controlled vocabulary.

THE MOST POPULAR API

Get links and metadata for the blog posts and articles that are most frequently e-mailed, shared and viewed by NYTimes.com readers.

THE MOVIE REVIEWS API

Get links to reviews and NYT Critics' Picks, and search movie reviews by keyword.

THE REAL ESTATE API